

Grooming Patterns



BIG IDEA Look at the whole pattern, since one message proves little: trust, then secrecy, then isolation, then escalation. You can tell at any stage, and telling is never too late.

1 HOOK 2'

2 ACTIVITY 8'

3 DISCUSS 3'

4 TAKEAWAY 2'

COUNSELOR HEADS-UP FIRST + OPT-OUT PLAN Counselor told (Appendix B). Teach mid-week, not next to Lessons 7 and 8. Family note sent; an opt-out is honored if asked. Show the Pass card.

PREP IN 5 MINUTES

Materials: R6: 12 timeline strips, four stage labels (TRUST, SECRECY, ISOLATION, ESCALATION), Safe or Unsafe Secret cards, Pass cards; Workbook CF-6.

- ☐ Cut and shuffle 12 strips per group; Pass cards on desks.
- ☐ Family note sent; counselor knows the day.
- ☐ Re-read the Analyst Rules and your disclosure steps.

1 HOOK 2 MIN *60-second script* Hackles up? When someone online asks you to keep secrets or pulls you away from others, trust that feeling. It is never your fault, and you can tell someone. “Most people you meet are fine. Today we spot an unusual pattern that can show up when someone builds a relationship that is not safe. It could be an adult, an older teen, or someone your age. People caught in it are smart and kind, and feeling flattered is human. The one using the pattern is responsible. This file is fictional, and you can use your Pass card at any time.”

2 ACTIVITY 8 MIN Timeline Strip Sort

- 1 (1 min) Read CF-6.** Luz, twelve, gets gifts and compliments from a teammate, then: “Let’s chat somewhere more private,” “Don’t tell your parents about me,” “Your friends are just jealous,” and a request for a private photo. Stop there. Add nothing.
- 2 (4 min) Strip Sort in groups.** Place 12 strips under TRUST (kindness, gifts), SECRECY (“don’t tell”), ISOLATION (“your friends do not get you”) or ESCALATION (lines crossed, pressure, threats). Star the earliest strip where Luz could have told.
- 3 (2 min) Debrief.** No single strip proves anything. The pattern does. Telling early makes it easier to stop, and later is never too late.
- 4 (1 min) Safe and Unsafe Secrets.** Thumbs up (a surprise party) or sideways (check it).

3 DISCUSS 3 MIN

- 1** “Which strips felt like kindness at first? When did the feeling change?”
- 2** “Why might Luz feel stuck or guilty? Did she do something wrong?” (No.)
- 3** “How is a safe friend or mentor different?” (Welcomes your other friends, accepts no.)

4 TAKEAWAY 2 MIN “Pause when someone asks for secrecy or pulls you from people you trust. Check the pattern: trust, secrecy, isolation, escalation. Tell a trusted adult at any point. It is never your fault, and never too late.”

Hand signal: Hackles Up (hand brushed up the neck, optional), then Pause, Check, Tell. Post it: “A surprise ends happy. A secret that squeezes your stomach gets shared.”

EXIT TICKET “A secret I should always tell a trusted adult about is _____. The first person I could tell is _____. Optional: “[] I would like to talk to the counselor privately.”

FUN BOOST Silent Gallery (calm; no scoring).

Groups leave their strip order, walk silently to one other table and say one thing that was the same or different.

LEVEL-UP Helper Poster. With counselor approval, design a school poster of the four stages and the Help Ladder, with no case details.

DIFFERENTIATE Pre-label strips, use eight, read aloud; pointing is fine.

FAMILY CARD Say: “A safe adult never asks you to keep a friendship secret from your family. You can tell me anything without getting in trouble.”

IF A STUDENT TELLS YOU SOMETHING

- **Say:** “Thank you for telling me. You did the right thing.”
- “This is not your fault. The person who did this is responsible.”
- “I can’t keep this secret. I need to bring in people who can help, and I will tell you who.”
- **Do not say:** “Why did you keep talking to them?” or “Are you sure?”
- “I won’t tell anyone.”
- Asking to see messages, photos or accounts.

First 10 Minutes: see the Disclosure Guide.

Then: tell your counselor or designated person right away; follow your school policy and your state’s reporting law (NCMEC CyberTipline for online cases). Never view, copy or forward an image.